

Chapter 68 - Companionship

Xu Yan leaned tiredly in the passenger seat, holding her phone and saying nothing, lost in thought. Qian He was driving the car, looking at her expression with some concern.

"Yan Yan, what's wrong with you? You look completely absent-minded?"

Xu Yan was silent for a moment. Instead of answering this question, she asked: "Do you feel that Feng Yue's emotions have been off since this afternoon?"

Hearing this, Qian He frowned as if carefully recalling, then responded: "It does seem like it, and I feel like she has something on her mind."

Xu Yan nodded. "You feel it too. When we left, I felt something was wrong with her, and just now after we separated, she seemed like she'd lost her soul."

Hearing this, Qian He stepped on the brake and stopped the car by the roadside.

Xu Yan was startled by her action, her body lurching forward due to inertia. "Hey! Why did you suddenly stop?"

Qian He's expression was somewhat anxious. "No, it's just that hearing you say this makes me worry about her. Should we call and ask?"

"She won't say anything. I asked her several times today. She probably doesn't want us to worry, so she's pretending she's fine."

"Then... then what should we do? We can't just do nothing, right?"

Xu Yan thought for a moment, then shook her head. "We need to make a phone call."

Qian He was puzzled.

"But not to Feng Yue. We need to find someone to go check on her situation."

After saying this, Xu Yan opened her phone, found a number, and dialed it.

The other end seemed busy, taking a while to answer.

"Hello? Who is this?"

Noisy background sounds came through the receiver, making Xu Yan frown.

The other person also seemed to feel that they couldn't have a proper phone conversation with all the background noise. After a while, the background sounds became less noisy.

Only then did Xu Yan say: "Miss Yan, this is Xu Yan. The person who was sitting next to Feng Yue earlier."

Yan Lin's eyebrows raised slightly, somewhat surprised. "Miss Xu, I remember you. Is there something you're calling me about?"

"It's like this - Feng Yue and I already left early, but when we were leaving, we noticed that Feng Yue's emotions might not be right. We also asked her, but she didn't say anything, just said she was fine."

Hearing this, Yan Lin's brow was already furrowed. She recalled seeing Feng Yue earlier - her state indeed wasn't quite right.

"Miss Xu, can you tell me specifically what happened?"

"We're not really clear about what's wrong with Feng Yue either. She was fine in the morning, and we even had lunch together at noon, but before the awards ceremony started, her emotions seemed off. We're afraid something might happen to her going home alone. If Miss Yan has time, could you go check on her?"

"I understand. I'll go. Thank you for calling, Miss Xu."

Yan Lin thanked Xu Yan before hanging up. She returned to the venue, got her car keys from Chang Ya, and hurriedly left.

Actually, the ceremony wouldn't last much longer. Yan Lin leaving early wouldn't have any impact, and even if there were other matters, Chang Ya could handle them perfectly.

Her main task now was to go see Feng Yue.

Xu Yan and Qian He didn't know about Feng Yue's illness, but Yan Lin was aware of it. So she was afraid that Feng Yue's lack of focus was caused by physical discomfort.

Yan Lin drove like the wind toward Song He Bay. Along the way, she called Feng Yue several times, but her phone was always turned off, making her even more worried.

The advantage of Yan Lin buying a house in Song He Bay now showed itself - she could enter the elevator without any obstacles and directly pressed the button for the fourteenth floor.

She kept dialing Feng Yue's phone, but all the prompts indicated it was turned off.

Yan Lin couldn't control her thoughts. Her mind was now filled with the last time she had seen Feng Yue in her previous life.

She had lain there so quietly and lifelessly on the hospital bed, her face pale, as if she had fallen into a deep sleep. If it weren't for the displays on the medical equipment beside her and the doctor's announcement, Yan Lin would never have believed that Feng Yue had left her just like that.

The elevator climbed floor by floor. The mirrored elevator door reflected Yan Lin perfectly.

Her hair was disheveled from rushing, her eyes were red from anxiety, her lips were tightly bitten from worry - everything showed Yan Lin's emotional state.

"Ding—" The elevator arrived.

The elevator hall with one elevator per household had been organized neatly by Feng Yue. The door to her home in the distance was tightly closed, with no indication of what might be happening inside.

Yan Lin took three steps as two and walked to the door. Just as she was about to knock, she heard faint sobbing sounds coming from inside.

This crying sound was like a large hand tightly gripping Yan Lin's throat, and a stabbing pain spread from her heart.

Yan Lin couldn't hold back anymore and reached out to press the doorbell at Feng Yue's door.

The sobbing sounds inside seemed to stop, and then the door opened.

Feng Yue's face covered with tear tracks and her reddened eyes appeared so clearly before Yan Lin.

A teardrop that seemed too late to wipe was trembling and hanging from Feng Yue's chin.

Feng Yue was crying.

This fact left Yan Lin extremely at a loss. She didn't know how to comfort her, nor did she know what she should say to console her at this moment.

So Yan Lin just looked at Feng Yue for a while.

Looking at her face full of tear tracks, looking at the endless darkness behind her.

Then Yan Lin moved. She reached out to grasp Feng Yue's wrist and pulled her back into a world full of light.

The lights in the elevator hall were voice-activated sensors, now working brightly and warmly.

Feng Yue fell into Yan Lin's embrace with a dazed expression. The familiar scent from the other person instantly enveloped her - it was both safe and suffocating.

Yan Lin held Feng Yue's waist with one hand and pressed tightly against the back of her head with the other, embracing her in the crook of her neck.

She murmured silently: "Thank goodness you're okay, thank goodness you're okay..."

Feng Yue had originally just wanted to vent her emotions alone and then return to normal, but at this moment, because of Yan Lin's embrace and comfort, her tears burst forth uncontrollably.

An inexplicable sense of grievance made her tears flow from her eyes like a broken string.

Her current state was like a child who had fallen down. If no one comforted her, she would pat her bottom and stand up again, but if someone was there coaxing her, the tears would become unstoppable.

The grievance of fighting the illness alone, the grievance of bearing memories from two lifetimes alone, the grievance of facing her predetermined death date alone.

All of this turned into a net called sorrow, covering her so tightly that she couldn't breathe.

Why did she have to bear all this, why was she the one who got this disease, why were all her efforts meaningless?

She just wanted to live well, to properly accompany her family.

Yan Lin felt her shoulder and neck area becoming wet, and silently reached out to gently stroke Feng Yue's spine again and again.

"It's okay, it's okay, everything will be okay." She murmured gently, clumsily yet carefully comforting the emotionally collapsed Feng Yue.

And Feng Yue, who had originally been forcibly pulled into the other person's embrace, subconsciously reached out and slightly grasped Yan Lin's clothing corner in her immense sadness.

Just this once, no matter who it was, let her have a good cry. She had borne too much alone, and she felt like she couldn't hold on much longer.

In the quiet and peaceful elevator hall, only Feng Yue's sorrowful weeping and Yan Lin's occasional comforting murmurs could be heard.

The long period of crying exhausted all of Feng Yue's remaining strength. The fatigue from deep in her brain made her fall defenseless into Yan Lin's embrace.

Yan Lin stood there holding her for as long as Feng Yue cried.

It wasn't until she felt Feng Yue fall into a deep sleep that she carefully carried her horizontally into the house.

This was Yan Lin's first time taking care of someone, and she looked somewhat clumsy. For example, she first placed Feng Yue directly on top of the covers, then realized this wasn't right and picked her up again to tuck her under the covers.

Looking at Feng Yue's face, messy from crying, Yan Lin got up and went to the bathroom to get some things to remove Feng Yue's makeup.

Fortunately, Feng Yue's makeup wasn't heavy, or else Yan Lin wouldn't have known what to do.

After taking care of Feng Yue, Yan Lin crouched beside the bed, carefully tracing Feng Yue's sleeping face.

Feng Yue's eyes were swollen from crying and would probably be worse tomorrow morning. Even though she was asleep, she was still occasionally hiccupping from crying.

Yan Lin simply sat cross-legged beside the bed and began thinking about what had happened to Feng Yue today.

Logically speaking, after Feng Yue knew about her condition, she would be able to control her emotions and not have such dramatic ups and downs.

But this time her emotions were unexpectedly agitated, and she cried for a long time without calming down.

Yan Lin frowned in thought. According to Xu Yan, A Yue's emotions were fine until before the red carpet started, so the only reason should be during that time period before the red carpet began.

Yan Lin pondered for a moment, and a flash of inspiration crossed her mind. She suddenly looked up - she probably knew when A Yue's emotions started to change.

Yan Lin took out her phone. Chang Ya had already sent that surveillance footage to her email.

Yan Lin opened the extracted video and watched it carefully.

At that time, all her attention was on Feng Yue, and she had never studied who Feng Yue was looking at.

The video showed that when Feng Yue saw her at the washbasin, she only paused her steps briefly. What completely stunned Feng Yue was the person who came out afterward.

Who was that person?

A trace of doubt flashed in Yan Lin's eyes. In the video, Feng Yue looked at that person for quite a while, and even when the other person left, her gaze followed them.

Could it be that this person was the culprit behind A Yue's emotional fluctuation today?

Yan Lin thought about this and immediately captured a screenshot of the person in the video and had someone investigate it.

Looking at it this way, A Yue's emotional fluctuation today wasn't due to her illness.

However, Yan Lin was still worried, so she would still personally fly to Germany again the next day.

Yan Lin watched over Feng Yue's bedside all night. The next day, she drove directly from Song He Bay to the airport.

The next morning, Feng Yue was awakened by an unbearable headache. However, when she opened her eyes, she felt more than just the headache.

Her throat and eyes were no exception.

She reluctantly sat up from the bed, wanting to get up and drink some water. Then she saw a cup of still-steaming warm water placed on her bedside table.

Feng Yue didn't think much about it and just leaned forward to pick up the cup and drink all the water in it. Only then did her throat feel much better.

Only then did Feng Yue have time to examine the things on her bedside table.

There was also a note on top.

[A Yue, I had a flight to catch this morning and couldn't stay with you. I poured you warm water and bought a heating cup pad to keep it warm. Remember to drink it. Also, use the egg in the bowl to apply a hot compress to your eyes, but it might be cold when you wake up, so remember to boil it again to heat it up.]

The note wasn't signed, but just thinking about who she had opened the door for last night, Feng Yue knew whose handiwork these things were.

Footnotes:

No specific cultural references requiring footnotes in this chapter.